

Cambridge IELTS 20

Academic Reading Test 2



3 Reading
Passages



40 Questions



60 Minutes

Candidate name:

Test date:

Test Instructions

General Rules

- The test contains three reading passages and 40 questions.
- Allow approximately 20 minutes for each passage.
- Read every instruction carefully before answering.
- Write answers in the spaces provided.
- Check spelling and word limits for completion tasks.
- Transfer and review all answers before the time ends.

Time Plan

01

Passage 1

Questions 1–13 — 20 minutes

02

Passage 2

Questions 14–26 — 20 minutes

03

Passage 3

Questions 27–40 — 20 minutes



Do not turn over until you are told to begin. Manage your time carefully — 20 minutes per passage is recommended.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

Manatees

Manatees, also known as sea cows, are aquatic mammals that belong to a group of animals called Sirenia. This group also contains dugongs. Dugongs and manatees look quite alike – they are similar in size, colour and shape, and both have flexible flippers for forelimbs. However, the manatee has a broad, rounded tail, whereas the dugong is fluked, like that of a whale. There are three species of manatees: the West Indian manatee (*Trichechus manatus*), the African manatee (*Trichechus senegalensis*) and the Amazonian manatee (*Trichechus inunguis*).

Unlike most mammals, manatees have only six bones in their neck – most others, including humans and giraffes, have seven. This short neck allows a manatee to move its head up and down, but not side to side. To see something on its left or its right, a manatee must turn its entire body, steering with its flippers.

Manatees have pectoral flippers but no back limbs, only a tail for propulsion. They do have pelvic bones, however – a leftover from their evolution from a four-legged to a fully aquatic animal. Manatees share some visual similarities to elephants. Like elephants, manatees have thick, wrinkled skin. They also have some hairs covering their bodies which help them sense vibrations in the water around them.

Seagrasses and other marine plants make up most of a manatee's diet. Manatees spend about eight hours each day grazing and uprooting plants. They eat up to 15% of their weight in food each day. African manatees are omnivorous – studies have shown that molluscs and fish make up a small part of their diets. West Indian and Amazonian manatees are both herbivores.

Manatees' teeth are all molars – flat, rounded teeth for grinding food. Due to manatees' abrasive aquatic plant diet, these teeth get worn down and they eventually fall out, so they continually grow new teeth that get pushed forward to replace the ones they lose. Instead of having incisors to grasp their food, manatees have lips which function like a pair of hands to help tear food away from the seafloor.

Manatees are fully aquatic, but as mammals, they need to come up to the surface to breathe. When awake, they typically surface every two to four minutes, but they can hold their breath for much longer. Adult manatees sleep underwater for 10–12 hours a day, but they come up for air every 15–20 minutes. Active manatees need to breathe more frequently. It's thought that manatees use their muscular diaphragm and breathing to adjust their buoyancy. They may use diaphragm contractions to compress and store gas in folds in their large intestine to help them float.

The West Indian manatee reaches about 3.5 metres long and weighs on average around 500 kilo grammes. It moves between fresh water and salt water, taking advantage of coastal mangroves and coral reefs, rivers, lakes and inland lagoons. There are two subspecies of West Indian manatee: the Antillean manatee is found in waters from the Bahamas to Brazil, whereas the Florida manatee is found in US waters, although some individuals have been recorded in the Bahamas. In winter, the Florida manatee is typically restricted to Florida. When the ambient water temperature drops below 20°C, it takes refuge in naturally and artificially warmed water, such as at the warm-water outfalls from powerplants.

The African manatee is also about 3.5 metres long and found in the sea along the west coast of Africa, from Mauritania down to Angola. The species also makes use of rivers, with the mammals seen in landlocked countries such as Mali and Niger. The Amazonian manatee is the smallest species, though it is still a big animal. It grows to about 2.5 metres long and 350 kilo grammes. Amazonian manatees favour calm, shallow waters that are above 23°C. This species is found in fresh water in the Amazon Basin in Brazil, as well as in Colombia, Ecuador and Peru.

All three manatee species are endangered or at a heightened risk of extinction. The African manatee and Amazonian manatee are both listed as Vulnerable by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). It is estimated that 140,000 Amazonian manatees were killed between 1935 and 1954 for their meat, fat and skin, with the latter used to make leather. In more recent years, African manatee decline has been tied to incidental capture in fishing nets and hunting. Manatee hunting is now illegal in every country the African species is found in.

The two subspecies of West Indian manatee are listed as Endangered by the IUCN. Both are also expected to undergo a decline of 20% over the next 40 years. A review of almost 1,800 cases of entanglement in fishing nets and of plastic consumption among marine mammals in US waters from 2009 to 2020 found that at least 700 cases involved manatees. The chief cause of death in Florida manatees is boat strikes. However, laws in certain parts of Florida now limit boat speeds during winter, allowing slow-moving manatees more time to respond.

PART 1 — QUESTIONS

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.

Appearance

– look similar to dugongs, but with a differently shaped **1** _____ *s*

Movement

– have fewer neck bones than most mammals

– need to use their **2** _____ *2* to help to turn their bodies around in order to look sideways

– sense vibrations in the water by means of **3** _____ *3* on their skin

Feeding

– eat mainly aquatic vegetation, such as **4** _____ *4*

– grasp and pull up plants with their **5** _____ *5*

Breathing

– come to the surface for air every 2-4 minutes when awake and every 15-20 while sleeping

– may regulate the **6** _____ *6* of their bodies by using muscles of diaphragm to store air internally

Questions 7-13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage?

in boxes on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

7 West Indian manatees can be found in a variety of different aquatic habitats.

8 The Florida manatee lives in warmer waters than the Antillean manatee.

9 The African manatee's range is limited to coastal waters between the West African countries of Mauritania and Angola.

10 The extent of the loss of Amazonian manatees in the mid-twentieth century was only revealed many years later.

11 It is predicted that West Indian manatee populations will fall in the coming decades.

12 The risk to manatees from entanglement and plastic consumption increased significantly in the period 2009-2020.

13 There is some legislation in place which aims to reduce the likelihood of boat strikes on manatees in Florida.



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14–26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.

Procrastination

A psychologist explains why we put off important tasks and how we can break this habit

A Procrastination is the habit of delaying a necessary task, usually by focusing on less urgent, more enjoyable, and easier activities instead. We all do it from time to time. We might be composing a message to a friend who we have to let down, or putting together an important report for college or work, we're doing our best to avoid doing the job at hand, but deep down we know that we should just be getting on with it. Unfortunately, berating ourselves won't stop us procrastinating again. In fact, it's one of the worst things we can do. This matters because, as my research shows, procrastination doesn't just waste time, but is actually linked to other problems, too.

B Contrary to popular belief, procrastination is not due to laziness or poor time management. Scientific studies suggest procrastination is, in fact, caused by poor mood management. This makes sense if we consider that people are more likely to put off starting or completing tasks that they are really not keen to do. If just thinking about the task threatens our sense of self-worth or makes us anxious, we will be more likely to put it off. Research involving brain imaging has found that areas of the brain linked to detection of threats and emotion regulation are actually different in people who chronically procrastinate compared to those who don't procrastinate frequently.

C Tasks that are emotionally loaded or difficult, such as preparing for exams, are prime candidates for procrastination. People with low self-esteem are more likely to procrastinate. Another group of people who tend to procrastinate are perfectionists, who worry their work will be judged harshly by others. We know that if we don't finish that report or complete those home repairs, then what we did can't be evaluated. When we avoid such tasks, we also avoid the negative emotions associated with them. This is rewarding, and it conditions us to use procrastination to repair our mood. If we engage in more enjoyable tasks instead, we get another mood boost. In the long run, however, procrastination isn't an effective way of managing emotions. The 'mood repair' we experience is temporary. Afterwards, people tend to be left with a sense of guilt that not only increases their negative mood, but also reinforces their tendency to procrastinate.

D So why is this such a problem? When most people think of the costs of procrastination, they think of the toll on productivity. For example, studies have shown that procrastination negatively impacts on student performance. But putting off reading textbooks and writing essays may affect other areas of students' lives. In one study of over 3,000 German students over a six-month period, those who reported procrastinating over their university work were also more likely to engage in study-related misconduct, such as cheating and plagiarism. But the behaviour that procrastination was most closely linked with was using fraudulent excuses to get deadline extensions. Other research shows that employees on average spend almost a quarter of their workday procrastinating, and again this is linked with negative outcomes. In fact, in one US survey of over 22,000 employees, participants who said they regularly procrastinated had less annual income and less employment stability. For every one-point increase on a measure of chronic procrastination, annual income decreased by US\$15,000.

E Procrastination also correlates with serious health and well-being problems. A tendency to procrastinate is linked to poor mental health, including higher levels of depression and anxiety. Across numerous studies, I've found people who regularly procrastinate report a greater number of health issues, such as headaches, flu and colds, and digestive issues. They also experience higher levels of stress and poor sleep quality. They are less likely to practise healthy behaviours, such as eating a healthy diet and regularly exercising, and use destructive coping strategies to manage their stress. In one study of over 700 people, I found people prone to procrastination had a 63% greater risk of poor heart health after accounting for other personality traits and demographics.

F Finding better ways of managing our emotions is one route out of the vicious cycle of procrastination. An important first step is to manage our environment and how we view the task. There are a number of evidence-based strategies that can help us fend off distractions that can occupy our minds when we should be focusing on the thing we should be getting on with. For example, reminding ourselves about why the task is important and valuable can increase positive feelings towards it. Forgiving ourselves and feeling compassion when we procrastinate can help break the procrastination cycle. We should admit that we feel bad, but not be overly critical of ourselves. We should remind ourselves that we're not the first person to procrastinate, nor the last. Doing this can take the edge off the negative feelings we have about ourselves when we procrastinate. This can all make it easier to get back on track.

PART 2 — QUESTIONS

Part 2

Questions 14-16

Questions 14-16

Reading Passage has six paragraphs,

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, **A-F**, in boxes on your answer sheet.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

14 mention of false assumptions about why people procrastinate

15 reference to the realisation that others also procrastinate

16 neurological evidence of a link between procrastination and emotion

Questions 17-22

Complete the summary below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes on your answer sheet.

What makes us procrastinate?

Many people think that procrastination is the result of **17** 17

Others believe it to be the result of an inability to organise time efficiently.

But scientific studies suggest that procrastination is actually due to poor mood management. The tasks we are most likely to put off are those that could damage our self-esteem or cause us to feel **18** 18 when we think about them. Research comparing chronic procrastinators with other people even found differences in the brain regions associated with regulating emotions and identifying **19** 19.

Emotionally loaded and difficult tasks often cause us to procrastinate.

Getting ready to take **20** 20 might be a typical example of one such task.

People who are likely to procrastinate tend to be either **21** 21 or those with low self-esteem.

Procrastination is only a short-term measure for managing emotions. It's often followed by a feeling of **22** 22, which worsens our mood and leads to more procrastination.

Questions 23-24

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**

Write the correct letters in boxes on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** comparisons between employees who often procrastinate and those who do not are mentioned in the text?

- A** Their salaries are lower.
- B** The quality of their work is inferior.
- C** They don't keep their jobs for as long.
- D** They don't enjoy their working lives as much.
- E** They have poorer relationships with colleagues.

Questions 25-26

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**

Write the correct letters in boxes on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** recommendations for getting out of a cycle of procrastination does the writer give?

- A** not judging ourselves harshly
- B** setting ourselves manageable aims
- C** rewarding ourselves for tasks achieved
- D** prioritising tasks according to their importance
- E** avoiding things that stop us concentrating on our tasks

Passage 3



You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27–40, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.

Invasion of the Robot Umpires

A few years ago, Fred DeJesus from Brooklyn, New York became the first umpire in a minor league baseball game to use something called the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS), often referred to as the ‘rob-umpire’. Instead of making any judgments himself about a strike*, DeJesus had decisions fed to him through an earpiece, connected to a modified missile-tracking system. The contraption looked like a large black pizza box with one glowing green eye, it was mounted above the press stand.

Major League Baseball (MLB), who had commissioned the system, wanted human umpires to announce the calls, just as they would have done in the past. When the first pitch came in, a recorded voice told DeJesus it was a strike. Previously, calling a strike was a judgment call on the part of the umpire. Even if the batter does not hit the ball, a pitch that passes through the ‘strike zone’ (an imaginary zone about seventeen inches wide, stretching from the batter’s knees to the middle of his chest) is considered a strike. During that first game, when DeJesus announced calls, there was no heckling and no shouted disagreement. Nobody said a word.

For a hundred and fifty years or so, the strike zone has been the game’s animating force – countless arguments between a team’s manager and the umpire have taken place over its boundaries and whether a ball had crossed through it. The rules of play have evolved in various stages. Today, everyone knows that you may scream your disagreement in an umpire’s face, but you must never shout personal abuse at them or touch them. That’s a no-no. When the robe-umpires came, however, the arguments stopped.

During the first robe-umpire season, players complained about some strange calls. In response, MLB decided to tweak the dimensions of the zone, and the following year the consensus was that ABS is profoundly consistent. MLB says the device is near-perfect, precise to within fractions of an inch. “It’ll reduce controversy in the game, and be good for the game,” says Rob Manfred, who is Commissioner for MLB. But the question is whether controversy is worth reducing, or whether it is the sign of a human hand.

A human, at least, yells back. When I spoke with Frank Viola, a coach for a North Carolina team, he said that ABS works as designed, but that it was also unforgiving and pedantic, almost legalistic. “Manfred is a lawyer,” Viola noted. Some pitchers have complained that, compared with a humans, the robot’s strike zone seems too precise. Viola was once a major-league player himself. When he was pitching, he explained, umpires rewarded skill. “Throw it where you aimed, and it would be a strike, even if it was an inch or two outside. There was a dialogue between pitcher and umpire.”

The executive tasked with running the experiment for MLB is Morgan Sword, who’s in charge of baseball operations. According to Sword, ABS was part of a larger project to make baseball more exciting since executives are terrified of losing younger fans, as has been the case with horse racing and boxing. He explains how they began the process by asking fans what version of baseball they found most exciting. The results showed that everyone wanted more action: more hits, more defense, more baserunning. This type of baseball essentially hasn’t existed since the 1960s, when the hundred-mile-an-hour fastball, which is difficult to hit and control, entered the game. It flattened the game into strikeouts, walks, and home runs – a type of play lacking much action.

Sword’s team brainstormed potential fixes. Any rule that existed, they talked about changing – from changing the bats to changing the geometry of the field. But while all of these were ruled out as potential fixes, ABS was seen as a perfect vehicle for change. According to Sword, once you get the technology right, you can load any strike zone you want into the

system. “It might be a triangle, or a blob, or something shaped like Texas. Over time, as baseball evolves, ABS can allow the zone to change with it.”

“In the past twenty years, sports have moved away from judgment calls. Soccer has Video Assistant Referees (for offside decisions, for example). Tennis has Hawk-Eye (for line calls, for example). For almost a decade, baseball has used instant replay on the base paths. This is widely liked, even if the precision can sometimes cause problems. But these applications deal with something physical: bases, lines, goals. The boundaries of action are precise, delineated like the keys of a piano. This is not the case with ABS and the strike zone. Historically, a certain discretion has been appreciated.”

I decided to email Alva Noe, a professor at Berkeley University and a baseball fan, for his opinion. “Hardly a day goes by that I don’t wake up and run through the reasons that this [robe-umpires] is such a terrible idea,” he replied. He later told me, “This is part of a movement to use algorithms to take the hard choices of living out of life.” Perhaps he’s right. We watch baseball to kill time, not to maximize it. Some players I have met take a dissenting stance toward the robots too, believing that accuracy is not the answer.

According to Joe Russo, who plays for a New Jersey team, “With technology, people just want everything to be perfect. That’s not reality. I think perfect would be weird. Your teams are always winning, work is always just great, there’s always money in your pocket, your car never breaks down. What is there to talk about?”

*strike: a strike is when the batter swings at a ball and misses or when the batter does not swing at a ball that passes through the strike zone.

PART 3 — QUESTIONS

Part 3

Questions 27-32

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage?

In boxes on your answer sheet, write

YES if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

YES	if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO	if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN	if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

27 When DeJesus first used ABS, he shared decision-making about strikes with it.

28 MLB considered it necessary to amend the size of the strike zone when criticisms were received from players.

29 MLB is keen to justify the money spent on improving the accuracy of ABS’s calculations.

30 The hundred-mile-an-hour fastball led to a more exciting style of play.

31 The differing proposals for alterations to the baseball bat led to fierce debate on Sword's team.

32 ABS makes changes to the shape of the strike zone feasible.

Questions 33-37

- A. pitch boundary
- B. numerous disputes
- C. team tactics
- D. subjective assessment
- E. widespread approval
- F. former roles
- G. total silence
- H. perceived area

Complete the summary using the list of phrases, **A-H**, below.

Write the correct letter, **A-H**, in boxes on your answer sheet.

Calls by the umpire

Even after ABS was developed, MLB still wanted human umpires to shout out decisions as they had in their **33**

..... . The umpire's job had, at one time, required a **34**
..... about whether a ball was a strike. A ball is considered a strike when the batter does not hit it and it
crosses through a **35** extending approximately from the batter's knee to his chest.

In the past, **36** over strike calls were not uncommon, but today everyone accepts the
complete ban on pushing or shoving the umpire. One difference, however, is that during the first game DeJesus used ABS,
strike calls were met with **37**

Questions 38-40

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**.

38 What does the writer suggest about ABS in the fifth paragraph?

- A** It is bound to make key decisions that are wrong.
- B** It may reduce some of the appeal of the game.
- C** It will lead to the disappearance of human umpires.
- D** It may increase calls for the rules of baseball to be changed.

39 Morgan Sword says that the introduction of ABS

- A** was regarded as an experiment without a guaranteed outcome.
- B** was intended to keep up with developments in other sports.
- C** was a response to changing attitudes about the role of sport.
- D** was an attempt to ensure baseball retained a young audience.

40 Why does the writer include the views of Not and Russo?

- A** to show that attitudes to technology vary widely
- B** to argue that people have unrealistic expectations of sport
- C** to indicate that accuracy is not the same thing as enjoyment

D to suggest that the number of baseball fans needs to increase

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key & Explanations

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
1	tail	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the manatee's tail is broad and round. This describes how the tail of a manatee looks and how it is not the same as the dugong's tail, which is shaped differently. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'Tail.' This means the back part of the manatee that looks different from the dugong's tail. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'Tail' because the passage says that manatees have a 'broad, rounded tail,' while dugongs have a tail that is fluked, like a whale's. This shows how their tails are different in shape.
2	flippers	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when a manatee wants to see something to its left or right, it has to turn its whole body. It uses its flippers to help steer while it swims. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'Flippers'. Flippers are the body parts that manatees use to help turn their bodies. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'Flippers' because the passage explains that manatees have to use their flippers to turn their bodies in order to look sideways since they cannot move their heads that way. Flippers help them steer while swimming.
3	hairs	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that manatees have some hairs on their bodies. These hairs are important because they help manatees feel vibrations in the water. Answer Explanation: The answer 'Hairs' means the little soft parts on the skin of manatees that help them to sense or feel things. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'Hairs' because the passage specifically talks about how manatees have hairs that help them sense vibrations in the water. This is important for their movement and awareness of their environment.
4	seagrasses	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that manatees eat a lot of seagrasses and other plants found in the water, which are an important part of their food. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'Seagrasses'. This means that seagrasses are a type of plant that manatees eat most of the time. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'seagrasses' because the passage says that manatees eat mainly aquatic plants, and specifically mentions that 'Seagrasses and other marine plants make up most of a manatee's diet.' This shows that seagrasses are a key part of what manatees eat.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
5	lips	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that manatees do not have certain teeth for grabbing food. Instead, they have lips that work like hands to help them take food from the ground in the water. Answer Explanation: The answer 'lips' means that manatees use their lips to grab and pull food. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'lips' because manatees don't have front teeth like other animals to grab food; instead, they use their lips, which act like hands to help them pull plants from the water.
6	buoyancy	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that manatees use muscles in their body to help change how they float in the water. Answer Explanation: The answer 'buoyancy' means how something floats in water. In this case, it is about how manatees manage to float in the water. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'buoyancy' because the passage explains that manatees use their diaphragm and breathing to help adjust their buoyancy, which means how they float. It shows how they use their muscles to help them stay at the right level in the water.
7	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that West Indian manatees can be found in both fresh and salty water. They use many water areas such as mangroves, coral reefs, rivers, lakes, and lagoons. Answer Explanation: The answer means that West Indian manatees live in different types of water places. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage says that the West Indian manatee moves between fresh water and salt water. It takes advantage of many habitats like coastal mangroves, coral reefs, rivers, lakes, and inland lagoons, showing that they can be found in a variety of different aquatic environments.
8	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that in winter, the Florida manatee stays in Florida and goes to warm places when the water is too cold. But it doesn't tell us how warm the waters are for the Antillean manatee. Answer Explanation: The answer means that we do not know if the Florida manatee lives in warmer waters than the Antillean manatee. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'NOT GIVEN' because the passage does not provide direct information comparing the water temperatures where the Florida manatee and the Antillean manatee live. It only says that the Florida manatee prefers warmer areas in winter, but it does not mention the Antillean manatee's specific temperature needs.
9	False	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that the African manatee lives in both the sea along the west coast of Africa and in rivers. It mentions that they can be found in countries like Mali and Niger, which do not have coastlines. This means they are not limited only to coastal areas. Answer Explanation: The answer is FALSE. This means that the statement about the African manatee's range is not correct. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is FALSE because the passage says the African manatee is found not only in coastal waters but also in rivers, including landlocked countries such as Mali and Niger. This shows that their range is not limited to just coastal waters.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
10	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that many Amazonian manatees were killed between 1935 and 1954, but it does not explain if people found out about this many years later. Answer Explanation: The answer is NOT GIVEN. This means that the passage does not tell us if the loss of Amazonian manatees was revealed only later. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because the passage talks about the number of Amazonian manatees killed between 1935 and 1954, but it does not say when this information became known or revealed. There is no information that directly answers the question.
11	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that the two types of West Indian manatees are expected to become less common by 20% in the next 40 years. Answer Explanation: The answer means that it is expected that there will be fewer West Indian manatees in the future. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage states that both subspecies of the West Indian manatee are listed as Endangered by the IUCN and that they are both expected to undergo a decline of 20% over the next 40 years.
12	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage talks about a study of around 1,800 cases of manatees getting caught in fishing nets and consuming plastic from 2009 to 2020. It says that 700 of those cases involved manatees, but it does not say if this number is a lot or if the problem became much worse. Answer Explanation: The answer is NOT GIVEN. This means there is not enough information to say if the risk to manatees from entanglement and plastic got much worse between 2009 and 2020. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because the passage mentions an examination of cases of entanglement and plastic consumption among marine mammals in US waters from 2009 to 2020 but does not say if the risk specifically increased significantly. It only provides some numbers and does not compare them to previous years.
13	True	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that there are laws in Florida that make boats go slower in winter. This gives manatees a better chance to be safe and prevent being hit by boats. Answer Explanation: The answer is TRUE. This means that there is indeed a law in Florida that helps protect manatees from being hit by boats. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is TRUE because the passage states that 'laws in certain parts of Florida now limit boat speeds during winter, allowing slow-moving manatees more time to respond.' This indicates that there are rules to help manatees avoid accidents with boats.
14	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that many people wrongly think procrastination is because someone is lazy or can't manage their time well. Instead, studies show that it actually happens because of how we feel. Answer Explanation: The answer is B. This means that in paragraph B, the writer talks about wrong ideas people have about why procrastination happens. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because this paragraph says that many people think procrastination is due to laziness or bad time management. But the psychologist explains that it is really due to problems with managing feelings. This information helps us understand that there are common false beliefs about procrastination.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
15	F	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that we should accept our bad feelings when we procrastinate but not be too hard on ourselves. It reminds us that many people procrastinate, just like us. Answer Explanation: The answer is F. This means that in paragraph F, there is information about realizing that other people also procrastinate. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is F because this paragraph talks about managing our feelings when we procrastinate and mentions that we should remember we are not the only ones who procrastinate.
16	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that scientists used special pictures of the brain to see how it acts when people put off tasks. They found that people who often procrastinate have differences in areas of the brain that help with emotions and feeling safe. Answer Explanation: The answer is B. This means that paragraph B talks about how our feelings and the way our brain works can make us procrastinate. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because it explains that procrastination is not just about being lazy, but it is connected to how we feel and manage our emotions. The paragraph mentions that scientific studies found differences in the brain of people who procrastinate often compared to those who do not, showing a direct link between our emotions and procrastination.
17	laziness	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that many people think procrastination comes from laziness, but this is not true. Procrastination is really connected to how we feel about tasks. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'laziness'. This means that some people think procrastination happens because a person is lazy. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'laziness' because many people believe that procrastination comes from being lazy. However, the passage explains that this is a misconception. Procrastination is not really caused by laziness, but by problems with managing our mood and feelings about tasks.
18	anxious	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when we worry about how a task might affect us, like feeling less good about ourselves, we can feel anxious. This anxiety makes us want to skip doing the task. Answer Explanation: The answer 'anxious' means feeling worried or nervous about something. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'anxious' because procrastination often happens when people think about tasks that might hurt their self-esteem or make them feel bad. The passage explains that thinking about these tasks can make us feel anxious, which leads us to avoid them.
19	threats	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that studies using brain scans found that procrastinators have different brain areas that deal with feeling threats and managing emotions. This means that they might find tasks more scary or challenging than others, which contributes to why they put off doing them. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'threats'. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'threats' because the passage explains that when we think about tasks, they can make us feel bad or scared about ourselves, which leads to procrastination. The word 'threats' describes those feelings that can affect how we see ourselves.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
20	exams	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that some tasks, like getting ready for exams, are very hard and make people feel strong emotions. Because of this, many people want to avoid doing them, which is called procrastination. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'exams'. This means the tests that students take to show what they know. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'exams' because the passage talks about tasks that are hard and cause people to feel stressed. Studying for exams is one of those hard tasks that people often put off. This procrastination happens because thinking about these exams can make people feel anxious or low in self-esteem.
21	perfectionists	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that perfectionists are people who are very concerned about how their work is seen. This worry makes them likely to delay or avoid doing their tasks. Answer Explanation: The answer 'perfectionists' means people who want everything to be perfect. They worry about how others will judge their work. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'perfectionists' because the passage explains that this group of people tends to procrastinate. They feel worried about their work being judged, which makes them avoid starting or finishing tasks. This is a key reason why procrastination happens.
22	guilt	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that after we avoid doing tasks, we might feel better for a little while, but then we feel guilty. This guilt makes us feel worse and encourages us to keep procrastinating. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'Guilt'. This means feeling bad or sorry for something you did or didn't do. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'guilt' because the passage explains that after procrastination, people often feel guilty about not completing their tasks, which makes their negative mood worse and encourages them to procrastinate again.
23	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that workers who put things off make less money and don't keep their jobs for as long as those who do not delay their work. Answer Explanation: The answer means that people who often procrastinate make less money and keep their jobs for a shorter time than those who do not procrastinate. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A and C because the passage explains how procrastination affects employees. It says that those who procrastinate have lower incomes (A) and they have less job stability, meaning they do not keep their jobs for as long (C).
24	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that workers who put things off make less money and don't keep their jobs for as long as those who do not delay their work. Answer Explanation: The answer means that people who often procrastinate make less money and keep their jobs for a shorter time than those who do not procrastinate. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is A and C because the passage explains how procrastination affects employees. It says that those who procrastinate have lower incomes (A) and they have less job stability, meaning they do not keep their jobs for as long (C).
25	A	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that to stop procrastinating, we need to manage our feelings better. We should forgive ourselves if we procrastinate and be kind to ourselves. It also says we should avoid distractions that make us unable to concentrate on our tasks.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer means that we should not be too hard on ourselves when we delay tasks and we should avoid things that distract us from focusing on our work. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer includes suggestions for breaking the habit of procrastination. The passage mentions that forgiving ourselves and feeling compassion when we procrastinate can help break the cycle. It also talks about managing our environment to avoid distractions, which helps us focus on our tasks.
26	E	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that to stop procrastinating, we need to manage our feelings better. We should forgive ourselves if we procrastinate and be kind to ourselves. It also says we should avoid distractions that make us unable to concentrate on our tasks. Answer Explanation: The answer means that we should not be too hard on ourselves when we delay tasks and we should avoid things that distract us from focusing on our work. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer includes suggestions for breaking the habit of procrastination. The passage mentions that forgiving ourselves and feeling compassion when we procrastinate can help break the cycle. It also talks about managing our environment to avoid distractions, which helps us focus on our tasks.
27	No	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that DeJesus did not decide what was a strike. He only received the decisions through an earpiece. Answer Explanation: The answer is NO. This means that DeJesus did not share decision-making about strikes with the ABS. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NO because the passage explains that DeJesus did not make decisions himself. Instead, he received the strike calls through an earpiece connected to the ABS system. This shows he was not sharing decision-making; he was just announcing what the system told him.
28	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that MLB changed the size of the strike zone after hearing complaints from players. This means they listened to the players and believed the changes were necessary. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the MLB agreed to change the size of the strike zone because players complained about it. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage states that when players complained about strange calls, MLB decided to change the dimensions of the strike zone. This shows that they took the players' criticisms seriously and made changes.
29	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage asks if it is good to reduce arguments in baseball, but it does not provide clear information about MLB wanting to justify spending money on accuracy. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'NOT GIVEN' because the passage does not clearly say whether MLB justifies the money spent on improving the accuracy of ABS. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'NOT GIVEN' because the passage discusses the efforts of MLB to improve baseball and mentions the technology of ABS, but it does not specifically state that they want to justify the money spent on making ABS more accurate.
30	No	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that this kind of play does not have a lot of action. This means that it is not exciting. Answer Explanation: The answer is NO. This means that the writer does not think that the fastball made the game more exciting.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NO because the passage explains that the fastball led to fewer exciting moments, resulting in more strikeouts, walks, and home runs. This lack of action is seen as not exciting. The writer mentions that after fastballs became common, baseball changed into a style lacking excitement, which does not agree with the statement.
31	Not Given	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that Sword's team thought about changing many rules, including the baseball bat, but then decided not to change them. It does not tell us if they argued over this. Answer Explanation: The answer means that we don't know if there was strong disagreement about changing the baseball bat. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is NOT GIVEN because the passage does not talk about whether there was a fierce debate about changing the baseball bat on Sword's team. It mentions that they brainstormed changes but does not describe any arguments or disagreements.
32	Yes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that if the technology works well, ABS can create any type of strike zone shape, like a triangle or even a shape like Texas. This means that ABS can change the strike zone whenever baseball changes. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the writer believes ABS can change the shape of the strike zone. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is YES because the passage explains that once the technology for ABS is right, it can allow the strike zone to change in different shapes. This shows that ABS makes changes to the shape of the strike zone possible.
33	F. former roles	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that Major League Baseball (MLB) wanted human umpires to make decisions and announce them in the same way they did before the use of the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS). This suggests that the old way of letting umpires make calls is still important to MLB. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'F', which means 'former roles'. This indicates that MLB wants umpires to return to their original way of making calls. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'F' because the excerpt shows that MLB wanted umpires to announce calls like they did in the past, referring to the 'former roles' of umpires. This emphasizes that even with the new technology (ABS), the job as it was done before is still valued.
34	D. subjective assessment	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that before the ABS, when the umpire called a strike, he had to make his own choice or decision, not just follow rules. Answer Explanation: The answer means that the umpire had to decide if the ball was a strike based on his opinion. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'subjective assessment' because before the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS) was created, umpires had to use their own judgment to determine if a ball was a strike or not. This shows that calling strikes was not just about the rules, but also about what the umpire thought.
35	H. perceived area	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage describes that a strike is called when the ball goes through an area that is imagined, not a real line. This area goes from the knees to the chest of the batter. Answer Explanation: The answer is H, which means 'perceived area.' This means how people see or understand where something is.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'H' because the passage says that a ball is a strike if it passes through an imaginary zone that stretches from the batter's knees to the middle of his chest. This area is not a physical line but is understood as a 'perceived area'.
36	B. numerous disputes	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage tells us that for a long time, there have been many arguments in baseball about what counts as a strike. This means that in the past, people often disagreed about the calls the umpire made. Answer Explanation: The answer is 'B', which means there were many arguments in the past about strikes called by the umpire. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is 'B' because the passage explains that arguing about strike calls is very common in baseball history. It says, 'For a hundred and fifty years or so, the strike zone has been the game's animating force-countless arguments... have taken place over its boundaries...'. This shows how disputes were normal in the past.
37	G. total silence	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that when DeJesus made calls during the game, everyone was quiet. There were no complaints or shouts. This shows that people accepted the robot umpire's decisions. Answer Explanation: The answer is G, which means a lot of quietness. No one said anything. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is G because during the first game with the robot umpires, nobody argued or complained. There was total silence when the umpire made calls, showing that players and fans accepted the decisions given by the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS). This is in contrast to the past when there were often arguments about calls.
38	B	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains how umpires used to make calls based on their judgment. When pitchers aimed for a spot, even a little outside the strike zone, it could still be called a strike. There was communication or 'dialogue' between the pitcher and the umpire about these calls. Answer Explanation: The answer says that using ABS may reduce some of the appeal of the game. This means that with robots making the calls, the human connection and the excitement of arguments might go away. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is B because the passage talks about how ABS changes the nature of the game. It mentions that with the robot umpires, there are fewer arguments and this might take away from the excitement of the game. The word 'dialogue' in the excerpt highlights the personal interaction that used to make the game more engaging, which could be lost with ABS.
39	D	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage explains that Sword believed using ABS would help make baseball fun and exciting for younger people because they are worried that young fans are not as interested in baseball anymore. Answer Explanation: The answer means that Morgan Sword wanted to make sure baseball stays interesting for young fans. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is about how Sword saw the Automated Ball-Strike System (ABS) as a way to make baseball more exciting and appealing to younger fans. He and his team wanted to know what kind of baseball fans found most exciting and learned that people wanted more action in the game.
40	C	Excerpt/Passage Explanation: The passage says that some players do not agree with the robot umpires because they think that just being accurate is not good enough. They believe that the size of the strike zone needs some flexibility for the game to be enjoyable.

#	Correct Answer	Explanation
		Answer Explanation: The answer means that the writer included Not and Russo's thoughts to show that being correct in the game is not the same as having fun while watching it. Reason For Correctness: The correct answer is C because both Not and Russo express the idea that just being accurate or perfect in baseball does not mean that people will enjoy the game more. They suggest that the fun and excitement of baseball can come from imperfections and disagreements, making it more interesting for fans.